000-S-00275 (GSA-FSS)
October 21, 1965
SUPERSEDING (IN PART)
000-S-00278a (GSA-FSS)
June 16, 1964

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SHEARS, BARBERS'

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers barbers' shears generally used for cutting and trimming hair.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification. The barbers' shears covered by this specification shall be of one type and size as hereinafter specified.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-553 - Paper, Wrapping, Tissue.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151 - Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following publication, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, unless otherwise stated, forms a part of this specification:

National Bureau of Standards Handbook:

H28 - Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.

(Copies of the National Bureau of Standards Handbook may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402. Price may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustration. The illustration shown herein is for the convenience of identification, and is not intended to preclude the purchase of barbers' shears which are otherwise in accordance with this specification.

3.2 Materials. Materials used in the construction of barbers' shears shall be of the highest commercial quality, fully suited for each particular application and as specified herein. Materials shall be free from any defects and imperfections which might affect the serviceability of the finished product.

3.3 Threaded parts. Threaded parts shall be in conformance with the applicable requirements of National Bureau of Standards Handbook H28.

3.4 Identification marking. Each pair of barbers' shears shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or with a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.5 Finish. The blades and handles on each pair of barbers' shears shall be fully nickel-plated. The plating shall be electrodeposited nickel not less than 0.0002 inch thick.

3.6 Blades.

3.6.1 Blade hardness. The blades of the barbers' shears shall have a hardness on the Rockwell "C" scale of not less than 50 nor more than 61 (see 4.5.2 and 4.5.2.1).

3.6.2 Joining blades of barbers' shears. Blades of barbers' shears shall be joined by a screw.

3.6.3 Blade adjustments. Barbers' shears shall be adjusted for proper contact along the entire length of the blade cutting edges. The pressure between the blades shall not cause binding. The barbers' shears shall work smoothly with a minimum of effort, and there shall be no rough spots, blemishes or other defects (see 4.2.3.1 and 4.5.1).

3.7 Length of cut. The minimum length of cut shall be as specified in table I and shall be defined as the cutting edge of blades measured from the outer end of the blade (tip) to the point at which the blades cross one another in the fully opened position.

3.8 Handles. Handles shall be designed for a right-hand operator. Barbers' shears shall be furnished with all metal handles which shall have double rings and a finger rest on one handle.

3.9 Design. Barbers' shears shall be designed with both blades pointed, and shall be hot forged of carbon steel with a minimum carbon content of .55 percent. The shears shall conform to table I and shall be similar to figure 1.

Table I. - Barbers' shears.

Overall nominal length	Minimum length of cut	Minimum weight per dozen
Inches	Inches	Pounds
7-1/2	3	1-1/2

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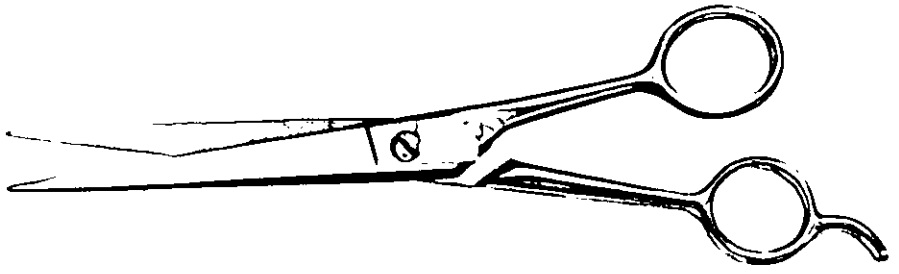


Figure 1. - Barbers' shears.

3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Barbers' shears shall be smoothly and fully finished with no rough or irregular edges. There shall be no unplated areas, except for the cutting edge and the inside of the blade. Excess flash or welds, or any other defects which detract from the appearance or which might impair the serviceability are not acceptable.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 Intermediate tests. Before plating, the blades of the barbers' shears shall be tested for Rockwell "C" hardness as specified in 4.5.2 to determine compliance with the applicable requirements of 3.6.1. A lot shall consist of blades heat-treated as a batch or under the same process and control. The lot size shall be expressed in pairs of blades for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 defects expressed in defects per hundred units.

4.2.3 End product inspection. Inspection of the barbers' shears shall be performed as specified in the following paragraphs. The lot size shall be expressed in units of barbers' shears offered for inspection at one time for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.3.1 Visual examination. Each sample unit shall be examined for defects set forth in table II below. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects expressed in defects per hundred units.

Table II. - Visual examination.

Examine	Defects	Major	Minor
Coating	Missing or not as specified.	X	
	Evidence of rust.	X	
Design	Any characteristic not in accordance with specified requirements.	X	
Construction	Part missing.	X	

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Table IL - Visual examination (Cont'd).

Examine	Defect	Major	Minor
Workmanship	Sharp burr or edges that may be injurious to personnel.	X	
	Not joined as specified.	X	
	Loose or not in proper alignment.	X	
	Any adjustable part that cannot be adjusted or is not properly adjusted to perform the function intended.	X	
	Functional part that requires abnormal force to operate.	X	
	Cracked, broken, malformed, bent, bowed, or otherwise damaged.	X	
	Ragged or damaged cutting edges.	X	
Threads	Stripped, broken or damaged.	X	
Marking identification	Missing, incomplete, not legible, not permanent or not as specified.		X

4.2.3.2 Dimensional examination. Each sample unit shall be examined to determine compliance with the dimensional requirements specified herein. Any dimension that is not within the specified requirements shall be classified a defect. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 1.5 defects expressed in defects per hundred units.

4.2.3.3 Testing of the end item. Each sample unit shall be tested for cutting performance to the applicable tests specified under 4.4 to determine compliance with the applicable requirements specified in 4.5. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 1.0 defects expressed in defects per hundred units.

4.2.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table III. - Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.
Contents	Number per container is more or less than required (applicable to level A packaging).
Weight	Gross weight exceeds requirement.
Preservation	Preservation improperly applied or missing, barrier material wrap missing or wrong type, grade, and class used; wrap not sealed with tape, improper set up boxes used.

4.3 Carbon content. The supplier shall furnish certification that the chemical composition of each lot or batch of steel used in the end item meets the applicable carbon requirements as specified in 3.9.

4.4 Lot acceptance tests. Each of the sample barbers' shears taken in accordance with 4.2.3.3 shall be tested as specified in 4.5.1 and 4.5.2 to verify compliance with the requirements of this specification. Any sample barbers' shears which do not meet the requirements for the cutting tests shall be rejected, and if the number of nonconforming barbers' shears in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.5 Test procedures.

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4.5.1 Cutting tests. Each sample shall be submitted to hand-cutting tests using the following material: Cotton sheeting, plain weave, 56 X 60 threads per inch and 3.8 ounces per square yard. The material used in the test shall be cut cleanly, without any drag or pull, and shall fall freely away from the cutting edges, including the points. The cutting test shall consist of cutting one thickness of cotton sheeting for one-fourth of the length of the cutting blade measured from the point.

4.5.2 Hardness tests. The Rockwell hardness tests shall be conducted in accordance with method 243 of Fed. Std. No. 151.

4.5.2.1 Blade hardness. The blades of each sample barbers' shears shall be tested to determine compliance with the hardness requirements specified in 3.6.1. Readings shall be taken within 1/8 inch from the cutting edge.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Each pair of shears shall be wrapped in paper conforming to UU-P-553 and packaged in accordance with method IC-1 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Six pairs of shears of like description shall be intermediate packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Unit packaging. Each pair of shears shall be wrapped in paper conforming to UU-P-553 and packaged in a paper envelope or plastic bag.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate packaging. Six pairs of shears of like description shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676.

5.1.3 Level C. The shears shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Intermediate packages of shears of like description shall be packed in quantities as specified (see 6.1) in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve intermediate packages of shears of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The shears shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in paragraphs 5.1.2.1, 5.1.2.2 and 5.2.2 (see 6.2).

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.1), the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.1), the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

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(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) Quantities of intermediate packages required (see 5.2.1).
(d) Any special marking for shipment required (see 5.4).

6.2 Standard pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.3 are intended for use in procurements of Stores Stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue or shipment to eventual user.

6.3 Superseding data. The barbers' shears in this specification supersedes type I, class 5 barbers' shears in Interim Federal Specification GGG-S-00278a(GSA-FSS) and Federal Specification GGG-S-278.

6.4 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:
Barbers' shears, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34,
Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:
Barbers' shears, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115,
National Motor Freight Classification.

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